

and a day, and the freeholder must start again from scratch. If the roll botches, the freeholder also takes an unsoakable amount of lethal damage equal to the freehold's rating.

No matter what method the freeholder uses, she must always invest at least 1 dot of personal Glamour to anchor the balefire.

Step Five: Freehold

The final step is shaping the artificial structures and landscaping that comprise the freehold's physical appearance, as well as shaping the freehold's appearance in the Dreaming. It may be as simple or complex as the freeholder desires. This step is never truly complete. It's an ongoing process, as maintaining the features of a freehold nurtures the Glamour, encouraging it to flow smoothly.

Freeholders may use Arts to shape the Dreaming aspects, though making such effects permanent requires the expenditure of Glamour (1 point per level of the Art). This is in addition to any Glamour costs the cantrip requires.

Example Freeholds

Freeholds come in all shapes and sizes, from tiny meadows in the forest to grand, elaborate castles that sprawl over acres of ground.

Cenote

Holdings ⑤ (Grotto)

The Mayan people believed that cenotes, circular pits of crystalline water peppered across the Yucatan Peninsula, were gateways into the afterlife. Through them, it was believed that sacrificial offerings might reach the gods, and many pits are littered with personal items and ancient bones. Some larger cenotes, such as the Sacred Cenote near Chichen Itza, are famous, but most hold only a trickle of power and are hidden in cliffs and forest. The cenote's hearthstone normally lies at the bottom of the pit.

Molly's

Holdings ②② (Hearth)

Molly's is a small Irish pub in downtown Boston protected by a Treasure bell above the door that makes mortal eyes ignore the building. Inside, Molly's boasts a welcoming atmosphere, with the balefire burning in the hearth and a waiting mug of house ale on the bar top. A doorway in the back leads directly into the Dreaming, and upstairs rooms offer a night's hospitality to weary travelers.

Whitehall Keep

Holdings ③③③ (Manor)

Granted to the Baron of Vellumton in the Kingdom of Willows, Whitehall Keep serves as the seat of power for Baron Arawn and Baroness Ellawyn. Its mortal aspect is that of an elegant Victorian bed-and-breakfast. In the Dreaming, Whitehall Keep is a sprawling mansion befitting its owners' status. Every summer, the barony hosts a medieval re-enactment festival, where mortals and changelings can mingle freely.

Shimmer Alley

Holdings ③③③③ (Market)

In between the busy streets of the Kingdom of Roses, Shimmer Alley turns brisk trade. A permanent market in the Dreaming, the freehold has many entrances in side streets and tucked-away shops all over London, and boasts many exotic goods from far-flung corners of the Dreaming. Accorded neutral territory, one might even find Gallain or Hsien here, browsing wares or hawking goods.

Tara-Nar

Holdings ③③③③③ (Stronghold)

The Stronghold of Dreams, Tara-Nar is the seat of power and primary residence of the High King, David Ardry. Located in upstate New York, it is an imposing and splendid castle reminiscent of French architecture, protected by the geography of the Catskills and the Red Branch Knights. The walls reflect the changing weather, painting patterns in accordance with the sun, wind, and rain on the translucent stone. Formal gardens and a tourney field surround the palace, and stables, mews, and kennels occupy outbuildings.

Chimera

The Dreaming is a place of chimerical wonder, and every part of it springs from the collective imaginings and dreams of humanity over a span of thousands of years. No matter where in the Dreaming a changeling finds himself, he can be sure even the smallest stone or the mightiest mountain came from the mind of a Dreamer. "Chimera" is the catch-all term changelings use to describe everything within the Dreaming or a dream realm, from the clouds in the sky (and the sky itself), to the trees and rocks, to the rabbits and jabberwocks frolicking in the field. To say that chimera is a key component to all known parts of the Dreaming is about as defining as saying carbon is a key component to all known life on Earth.

What exactly comprises chimera is an enigma. Though many fae have made a study of dreamstuff, all but the most basic properties escape definition. Changelings can't even be certain that chimera are, in fact, *real*: Though the fae and the enchanted can observe chimera with all five senses, chimera cannot affect the mundane world except under special circumstances.

The dreamstuff that makes up a chimera's form is somewhere between Glamour and Banality. It is crude yet elegant, able to retain a shape while being malleable, and can change its properties so that it mimics flesh, grass, leaves, fur, breath, rock, water, soil, ice, fire, dragon scales, or anything else a person can dream.

Chimera can be broadly categorized by whether they are incidental or dreamed, whether they are animate or inanimate, and whether they are sentient or non-sentient. The Dreaming offers no hard, fast rules on what combinations of these broad categories can exist: a tree might just be a tree, (incidental, non-sentient and inanimate), but it might also be an Ent (dreamed, sentient and animate).